

Rain Forces Phillies To Shift Drill

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Sports Editor*

CLEARWATER, Fla., March 18.—The Phillies, who also should be thinking of signing Johnny Weissmuller or maybe Lloyd Bridges as coach, had another plan today to throw at this horribly wet Florida weather.

When a third straight day of downpour washed out the exhibition date here with the Yankees yesterday, General Manager John Quinn got on the phone and tried to find some dry spot in the general area where the Phils at least could do some running. Both fields here—handsome Jack Russell Stadium and the neighboring practice diamond—look like lagoons.

Palmetto Drill Site

Quinn wound up with the Palmetto, Fla., High School diamond, 40 miles to the South, near Quinn's old Milwaukee training camp of Bradenton. They haven't had any rain there and the high school coach said sure, come on down. So 41 Phils went by bus and managed to get in seven intrasquad innings that amounted to a glorified batting practice.

There wasn't much chance that the Phils would be able to play today's exhibition game against the Redlegs at Tampa, which also has been soaked. A "B" squad contest here with the Cardinals looked as if it didn't have a chance because the Clearwater fields aren't fit for practice, let alone games.

So Quinn found another friend in Rick Ferrell, general manager of the Detroit Tigers. They are training in Lakeland, about 90 minutes away, and have a converted airplane hangar available for indoor practice. It has wall-to-wall dirt, six pitching mounds and a batting net.

The Phillies have permission to use the hut this afternoon, if they aren't able to do anything in Clearwater or Tampa.

The desperate Manager Eddie Sawyer had to be happy to grace the high school diamond at Palmetto yesterday, for the Phils have been able to do little but warm up their pitchers under the stands of Russell Stadium. Two teams led by Coaches Dick Carter and Andy Cohen scrimmaged and the Cohens won, 5 to 2.

Neiger Pitches

Wilmington's Al Neiger pitched five innings for the losers, and Jack Meyer finished. Canadian rookie Bob Baillargeon and Dick Farrell worked for Cohen's victors. The pitchers threw only fast balls, because the batters needed work, too. Rookie Outfielder Tony Curry touched Neiger for an opposite-field home run on the fenceless diamond. Among other achievements, Ted Savage, an impressive Negro center fielder just out of the Army, had a single and double and Dave

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